

» AFTER

The US were proved right in their expectation of a major offensive. In March, the NVA and Viet Cong unleashed their most ambitious offensive of the war.

THREE-PRONGED ATTACK

The **Easter Offensive** began on March 30. It turned out to be a three-pronged attack, across the DMZ, from the west into the Central Highlands, and from Cambodia toward Saigon in the south, employing conventional tactics and weapons. The **ARVN**, supported by massive US airpower, faced its greatest test so far.

BOMBING THE NORTH

In May 1972, Nixon ordered **Operation Linebacker**, the bombing of **military sites, roads, and bridges** in North Vietnam. He also ordered the mining of **Haiphong Harbor**, a major entry point for armaments and supplies from North Vietnam's allies.